Explanation for Self-Assessment of Japanese Language Skills

Ryukoku University launches the Ryukoku Japan Studies Program (JSP) for international exchange students in the 2026 Academic Year.

The goal of this program is to take advantage of the benefits of living in Japan in order to ① Gain a variety of experiences both within and outside of Ryukoku University and ② Improve one's Japanese language skills and gain insights into the societies and cultures of various countries through interactions with Japanese students and other international students.

To achieve this, the program incorporates project-based learning in Japanese classes, such as through interviews and surveys. It also makes use of Japan's social and cultural settings – especially the unique location of Kyoto – by including activities such as the observation of festivals and other traditional events.

< Class Example (JSP-B Class) >

Topic	Objectives	Activities
Travel and Transportation	When presenting about one's country and hometown, if there is adequate preparation ahead of time, can provide a somewhat detailed introduction about famous places, famous items, etc.	・Learn vocabulary and expressions to explain one's hometown and to explain both one's town and the places one has been ・Make a poster to introduce one's hometown
Emergency Situations	In the case of an accident or disaster, can understand an explanation or instructions if the speaker's accent is sharp.	・Read an evacuation drill notice for information. Know important details at the time of evacuation ・Visit the Kyoto City Disaster Prevention Center and listen to the explanation and instructions
Student Life	Understands how school circumstances differ according to country and region and is able to express (to some extent) one's own opinions in detail.	・Through texts, gain an understanding of education in Japan ・Read a pamphlet of Ryukoku University-affiliated Heian Junior/Senior High School and understand the contents ・Visit Ryukoku University-affiliated Heian Junior/Senior High School to observe a class and have a discussion with the instructors ・Give a presentation on one's findings from the visit
Different Cultures	With enough prior preparation, can provide a somewhat detailed speech about the differences between Japan and one's home country, as well as Japan's surprising aspects.	・Attend the Gion Festival and watch the procession of *Yamahoko* floats ・Conduct an interview in the Fushimi Momoyama shopping arcade ・Provide a five-minute speech on the theme of cultural differences

Furthermore, with the aim of broadening students' practical Japanese language skills, objectives are set and class activities are carried out by using the Common European Framework of Reference (CEFR) "Can Do" system as a reference. Using this standardized system, the students' home university Japanese language instructors and other related individuals can share Japanese language learning progress information more easily. In addition, our curriculum is composed of designated classes which align with the CEFR levels. Students in higher-level classes are eligible to enroll in regular undergraduate or graduate-level subjects.

< Organization of Classes >

Japanese Classes in the Ryukoku Japan Studies Program (JSP) are organized into four levels (JSP-II ~ JSP-V) which adhere to the CEFR framework. For each skill (Listening, Reading, Interaction, Speaking, Writing), learning objectives are set using "Can-Do" statements. The table below shows provides an overview of the "Can-Do" objectives for each class.

Can-Do Objective Examples (by Class)

Class	Target Level	Can-Do Objectives
JSP-V	B2.2	The student Is able to use the language fluently, accurately, and effectively on a wide range of subjects. Communication is natural, using correct grammar and a level of politeness appropriate for the situation. Interviews are carried out smoothly and effectively, with questions adjusted to fit the other party and an ability to draw out topics of great interest to the interviewee. The student is then able to write an article by summarizing the contents, selecting important points and including supplemental facts. The student absorbs numerous points of view in order to gain a broader understanding of Japanese culture, one's own culture, and the home culture of other international students.
	B2.1	The student is able to converse fluently and naturally, emphasizing points which are important to oneself and explaining related points in detail. The student is assertive in firmly explaining the basis of his/her own perspective. Regarding his/her field of interest, is able to integrate many pieces of information from their source and present them as grounds for an argument. In an interview, asks questions relevant to the other party and can draw out various topics of interest. Can gather the main points and compose an article with the reader in mind. Absorbs numerous points of view in order to gain a broader understanding of Japanese culture, one's own culture, and the home culture of other students.
	B1.2	When conducting a questionnaire, the student puts together results and is able to provide a simple presentation using graphs and data. Can put together a short article and speech and can state one's opinion. Is also able to answer detailed questions. Can find the information needed from a variety of informational sites, etc.. Is able to conduct an easy interview while confirming information and asking related questions, and can combine the results and compose an article.

JSP-Ⅳ	B1.1	With preparation, is able to give a detailed presentation. Can converse concretely on topics of interest. Is able to read and understand short and easy sentences. Can write short sentences about familiar content and topics of interest. Is able to understand and respect both similarities and differences between one's own culture, that of Japan, and that of other countries.
JSP-Ⅲ	A2.2	Can understand regularly used sentences and expressions regarding topics directly related to oneself such as personal information, family information, shopping, one's neighborhood and work, etc. Can exchange information about short and regular, everyday matters. Can explain, in easy words, necessary information about one's background and daily circumstances.
JSP-Ⅱ	A2.1	On short and familiar topics, can attain limited information by reading and listening. Can make a simple presentation and write a report with short sentences. Can converse and answer questions on simple, everyday topics.

Class placement is determined comprehensively based on the results of the "Self-Assessment of Japanese Language Proficiency" and the "SPOT Test.